

EFSPi Regulatory Statistics Workshop

Workshop Objectives, Guiding Framework, and Operational Principles

Date: 07 October 2026

Principles of the EFSPI RSW

Focus is on discussions less on presentations

- Presentations should motivate & guide the discussions
- The discussion is where the interaction takes place

Focus is on principles and not on statistical methodology

- For statistical methodology there are many other events
- We focus on strategic & regulatory development principles

Focus is on the why

- The why is essential to foster common understanding between regulators and industry

Focus is on 'hot' topics for industry or regulators

- To provide maximum value
- Identification: essential task of the Scientific Committee

Why is the EFSPI Reg Stat Workshop Different?

Workshop		Conference
Small	Scale	Large
Plenary (Single-Track)	Format	Parallel Sessions
Narrow, Strategic	Structure	Diverse, Technical
Quality	Focus	Quantity
Longer Coffee Breaks & Lunches	Networking	Shorter Breaks & Lunches
Ours	Outcome (Impression)	Mine
Low Cost, High Value	Cost / Value	High Cost, Variable Value
Targeted Invitation of SMEs	Program Curation	Open Call for Abstracts

Key themes of the workshop

Focus on OURS, not Mine

- Emphasizes "OUR" challenges over "My method"
- Single plenary track facilitates common focus vs. fragmented discussions
- Scientific Committee identifies and curates a program of the most important topics of mutual interest
- Create a safe space to discuss hard things

Create a lasting impact

Why is Discussion the Primary Focus?

- **Intentionally different**
 - There are many other conferences where people can present their latest methods inventions
- **Adoption of innovation is hard**
 - Clear statement of the problem
 - Understand barriers and where “the other side” is coming from
 - Create safe space for dialog
- **Relationships take time to build**
 - Understand different perspectives
 - Identify challenges / opportunities
 - Find common ground

Teams Organising the Workshop

- Local Organising Committee (LOC)
- Scientific Committee (SC)

Local Organising Committee (LOC)

Key Responsibilities of LOC – 1/2

- Steering the strategic direction of the workshop (overall)
- Anticipating and responding to challenges
- Balancing continuity with innovation
- Serving as the EFSPI council liaison
- Supporting and connecting the SC
- Overseeing the budget, payment administration, invoices & certificates
- Maintaining website updates, registration management, and surveys

Requires certain level of experience & familiarity with the WS and its core values

These responsibilities can be taken over by EFSPI members (local & non-local)

Key Responsibilities of LOC – 2/2

- Organization and coordination of
 - venue (access, equipment, relationships, ...)
 - catering, social event, ...
 - on-site support (welcome desk, badges, banner, ...),
 - student support & volunteers,
 - technicians (IT, zoom, cameras, mics, chat observers, ...).

These responsibilities require **local** EFSPI members and continuity regarding **relationships**

Composition

- Active and engaged members of the EFSPI biostatistics community with demonstrated interest and behaviors associated with getting things done, living the "OURS" vs. "MY" mindset, & making the workshop successful
- Ideally, each member takes clear responsibility and accountability for one (or more) of the following domains, in alignment with the Finance Lead:
 1. **Hospitality and logistics:** Point of contact with Biozentrum regarding facilities rental, coordination of poster boards, student helpers, local volunteers, catering, the social event/apero, speaker/panelist gifts, directing of invoices to EFSPI Finance. [LOCAL TASK]
 2. **Website:** Maintain and update; update/align attendee registration form, incl. dietary restrictions
 3. **Registration process:** Send meeting invitations to virtual and in-person attendees; verify that presenters and contributors are registered; and print badges for in-person attendees [LOCAL TASK]. Each company remains responsible for its own block bookings.
 4. **IT and Zoom webinar:** Set up the Zoom webinar; arrange a rental laptop and generic email address; share links with attendees in coordination with the registration team; test virtual attendance and slide projection; record sessions; edit videos to remove presentations from speakers who have not consented; and recruit volunteers for microphones, chat monitoring, and camera operation. [LOCAL TASK]
 5. **Finance:** budget, invoice handling, certificates of attendance, relationship to EFSPI admins.

LOC Chair: if not the same as SC chair, keep oversight over the local activities and needs and liaise with SC chair

SC Chair: Serve as liaison between the SC and LOC and assist with assigning door guards at Biozentrum

Continuity ensured through succession planning and shadowing, with a focus on local colleagues.

Please reach out if you would like to support. In particular, we always need helping hands at the workshop.

Scientific Committee (SC)

Scientific Committee – General Spirit

- Thorough Scientific Committee discussions help ensure that the program reflects shared strategic priorities
- The entire SC needs to review and debate proposed sessions and their key messages to ensure that the program addresses topics of collective relevance to drug development and forms a coherent whole*
- SC members represent the broader drug development community, not themselves or their individual company or institution

* Smaller dedicated teams may also work to map out sessions with the expectation of returning with these ideas for review with the entire SC

Scientific Committee – General Expectations

- Experienced drug developers with the ambition to put together an interesting, balanced, and discussion-focused program relevant for the audience
- Presence at preparatory meetings and active contribution to the planning (topics, questions, and speakers/panelists)
- Willingness
 - to bring back session considerations for approval to the full SC
 - to (co-)chair a session at the WS, implying the intention to attend in-person
- We aim for approximately equal representation of regulators / HTA and industry
- We aim for diversity: gender, region, companies, areas of expertise
(across all phases of drug development & specialties, e.g., HTA/RWD)

SC – Members

Regulators & HTA decision Makers

- Regulators and HTA representatives are each responsible for nominating their members to the SC

Industry

- LOC members can choose to engage in the SC, if interested and committed. They ensure continuity.
- Additional SC members – Recruitment and tenure
 - Call through EFSPI newsletter / e-mail list, workshop in closure and/or “poster” (via link to workshop webpage), EFSPI Council, LinkedIn, ESIGs (in case that particular expertise is required)
 - Tenure of two years, with the possibility to apply for a one-year extension
 - Current SC members will jointly review the applications and agree on the selection

SC Chair

SC Chair – Guiding Principles

- Max three years.
- Experienced drug developer.
- Ideally, former member of the scientific committee ("shadowing").
- Well connected in Europe and beyond (industry & regulators, ideally also academia).
- If located in Basel, the Scientific Committee Chair can opt to take over the role of the Local Organizing Committee Chair at the same time.
If not, the chairs of the SC and LOC need to agree the liaison between them.

Planning of Regular Sessions

Planning regular sessions

- Target duration is approx. 90 minutes (default), exception: short topics
- A few (2-3) short, succinct, and to-the-point talks should aim to highlight a problem, principles and the “why?” to enable a subsequent workshop-style discussion
- Topic should bring new aspects to the discussions and not simply re-use slides from other recent events. Redundancy is to be avoided. Topics should not be too broad.
- The ambition is for both industry and regulators to exchange views and to learn. It should be clear that a firm regulatory position cannot always be provided, especially when discussing draft guidelines.
- Role of the session chairs is to ensure that the presenters “do the work” to stimulate a discussion. This is a more demanding role for the chairs and, generally, more pre-planning is needed.
- Session chairs also need to ensure that presenters stick to deadlines and formatting requirements for slides.

Selection of Speakers & Panelists

- Speakers and panelists
 - are discussed only after the purpose and intent of a proposed session has been clarified and confirmed
 - are only invited after endorsement by the Scientific Committee
 - should be chosen to based on their qualification and skills to present, keeping diversity in backgrounds in mind
- The ambition is to broaden participation and avoid having the same speakers or institutions represented year after year
- Based on regular feedback, starting from 2026 we propose to invite maximum one panelist in addition to the session's speakers.